Girish Chandra (Gary) Saxena (IPS 1950 Uttar Pradesh, later governor of Jammu and Kashmir), had taken over as director (R) in April 1983 on Suntook's retirement. Though very senior to me, we both belonged to the Uttar Pradesh cadre and I knew him well from before we joined the R&AW. Gary called me in the second week of September 1983 and told me that the prime minster was due to visit New York for about six days, from 26 September to 2 October, to address the thirty-eighth UNGA session on 28 September, and would also attend some other functions.

According to him, the situation in Canada and the west coast of the US had worsened as far as the Sikh diaspora was concerned, and the threat to the PM's life from extremists had escalated as well. We needed to be extra cautious to ensure her safety during that visit. Also, to avoid adverse publicity in front of foreign heads of state attending the UNGA session, we needed to ensure that no demonstration by pro-Khalistan Sikhs took place in front of the UN building while she was addressing the UNGA. If that was not possible, we should at least see that the demonstrations remained a low-key affair.

I had no control over such developments or over the people who might be behind them as it was not a part of my current charge at the headquarters. Gary was, in fact, aware that what I had been doing so far on this front was based on my personal goodwill and friendship with persons who were in the know of things. Therefore I told Gary that I could not guarantee anything but I would try my best to comply with his instructions. I then discussed the details of my programme with Gary, to which he agreed.

I reached Ottawa on 21 September. By that time, High Commissioner Gurdial Singh Dhillon, whom I had met in December 1981, had been replaced by Sivarama Krishnan. On the completion of his tenure, my successor too had been replaced by another R&AW officer. I had a detailed discussion with our man on the prevailing situation in Canada, after which I called on the high commissioner alone. Both our man and the high commissioner were worried about the significant increase in pro-Khalistan activities in Canada, especially in the Toronto and Vancouver areas, but did not know what could be done to deal with the situation without any